that of some Englishmen with whom he came into contact—Sir James Grigg, who became the Finance Member, Sir James Taylor, his predecessor as RBI Governor, and Sir Jeremy Raisman, who was also a Finance Member. Grigg and Taylor had placed first and second in 1913 with 3,367 and 3,344 marks respectively. Raisman had stood first in 1916, scoring more than 3,600 marks.

Deshmukh's probation was at the School of Oriental Learning of London University, then housed in hired premises near the Bank of England and St. Paul's. Since he had already passed Hindu and Mohammedan Law in the Part I Bar examination, probation was not unduly strenuous. To avoid being subjected to undue influence and pressures, he had opted for United Provinces and CP and Berar rather than Bombay Province. Deshmukh came second in the probationary examination, with S.A. Lal topping the list, but since the gap in Deshmukh's marks and Lal's in the open examination was so great, on the basis of combined results which determined seniority, he still placed first. Deshmukh also passed Part II of his bar examination in the second class at about the same time.

In the meanwhile, Deshmukh had fallen in love and successfully proposed to an Englishwoman, Rosina in October 1919. He signed the ICS covenant in November 1919, but remained in London because he thought that he might get called to the Bar in January 1920. At the last moment he realized that he did not have the 27 guineas required to be paid before he could be called. In the event, he was called to the Bar at the Inner Temple forty-four years later! Since he already had a job, there was no urgency and Deshmukh returned to India with his bride in February 1920.

Deshmukh's first posting on his return to India was as Assistant Commissioner, Amraoti, in Berar. His training involved actual discharge of duties at lower levels and in a few months' time, he was considered ready to learn the work of a sub-divisional officer. His first posting as sub-divisional officer was at Chandur and later at Amraoti. Later, he was posted to Ellichpur as resident sub-divisional officer where he stayed for about one and a half years. After a stint in Raipur and Mahasamund, he was transferred to the Secretariat at Nagpur as under Secretary in the General Administration, Political and Judicial Departments—a charge never before given to an Indian. In early 1926, Deshmukh was transferred back as